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OSCE Stations

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OSCE Guides

Cardiovascular History | OSCE Checklist

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Introduction		
1	Wash your hands and don PPE if appropriate	
2	Introduce yourself to the patient including your name and role	
3	Confirm the patient's name and date of birth	
4	Explain that you would like to take a history from the patient	
5	Gain consent to proceed with taking a history	
Presenting complaint		
6	Start by using open questions to explore the patient's presenting complaint; facilitate the patient to expand on their presenting complaint	
History of presenting complaint		
7	Explore the presenting complaint in more detail using SOCRATES (site, onset, character, radiation, associated symptoms, time course, exacerbating and relieving factors, severity)	
8	Screen for key cardiovascular symptoms (e.g. chest pain, dyspnoea, palpitations, syncope, oedema, intermittent claudication)	
9	Explore the patient's ideas, concerns and expectations	
10	Summarise the patient's presenting complaint; signpost what you've discussed so far, and what you plan to discuss next	
Systemic enquiry		
11	Screen for relevant symptoms in other body systems	
Past medical history		
12	Ask if the patient has any medical conditions. Consider important risk factors for cardiovascular disease (e.g. hypertension, hyperlipidaemia)	
13	Ask the patient if they've previously undergone any surgeries or procedures (e.g. CABG, stenting, heart valve replacement)	

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Drug history		
14	Ask if the patient is currently taking any prescribed medications or over-the-counter remedies	
15	Ask if the patient has any allergies and if so, clarify what kind of reaction they had to the substance	
Family history		
16	Ask if there is any family history of cardiovascular disease. If present, clarify at what age the diseases developed in the relatives	
Social history		
17	Explore the patient's general social context (type of accommodation, who the patient lives with, how the patient manages with ADLs)	
18	Take a smoking history	
19	Take an alcohol history	
20	Ask about recreational drug use	
21	Ask the patient what their diet looks like on an average day	
22	Ask if the patient regularly exercises	
23	Ask about the patient's occupation	
24	Ask the patient about driving or operating heavy machinery	
Closing the consultation		
25	Summarise the key points	
26	Ask the patient if they have any questions or concerns that have not been addressed	
27	Thank the patient for their time	
28	Dispose of PPE appropriately and wash your hands	
Key communication skills		
29	Active listening	
30	Summarising	
31	Signposting	

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